



Let's Practice!

What are these strange events and coincidences?

Instructions: Match the statements from Column A to the ones on Column B. Read the complete sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

COLUMN A

1. Did your mobile phone go on the fritz
2. Due to the unreliability of anything related to technology, it is a bad
3. Mercury retrograde, a phenomenon that
4. This event, which entails the planet appearing to move backward in its orbit, has a direct
5. On the other hand, skeptics of this phenomenon

COLUMN B

- a. time to start new projects, travel, or do anything new that could fall apart later.
- b. occurs about three times a year, is the obvious culprit.
- c. and your hard drive start acting up within the last couple weeks?
- d. correlation with all things related to timing and traffic, transportation and communication.
- e. unable to provide a plausible alternative explanation.



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The author of the article has a lot of opinions about the role of astrology in our lives.

Instructions: Use the options from the Word Bank to correctly complete the sentences. Use capital letters where necessary. Read the complete sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

Word Bank

I firmly believe / we all know that Earth / it is
advised that people / who don't think that
astrology / I told you that

- 1) _____ Mercury retrograde was at the heart of my problems!
- 2) _____ and the rest of the solar system hold a mysterious past and that there are elements of our existence that cannot be fully explained.
- 3) _____ that Mercury retrograde is the culprit.
- 4) Similarly, _____ hold off on making important decisions during this unstable period.
- 5) And for the 55-69% of Americans _____ is credible, just remember: the planet Mercury will continue to exert its influence, whether you believe it or not.